

Customer Complaints Application

Business Requirements Document (BRD) – Proposed MVP

Prepared based on exstoAssist UI references and the Customer Complaints application requirements.

1. Executive Summary

The Customer Complaints application will provide a simple internal system for dealership users to register, manage, track, communicate, resolve, and close customer complaints. The application will take useful concepts from exstoAssist while intentionally reducing complexity. The primary user experience should be action-oriented: open the application, understand what needs attention, open a complaint, take action, and move it toward resolution.

The application will use a dashboard-first home page with KPI cards and charts for a quick summary of complaint volume, status, trends, and categories.

2. Objectives

- Provide a single place to manage the complete customer complaint lifecycle.
- Make complaint registration quick and simple.
- Provide clear ownership and assignment of complaints.
- Maintain a complete activity and communication history.
- Support customer communication through email and recorded phone interactions.
- Provide a dashboard for quick operational visibility.
- Provide simple reporting and export capabilities.
- Reuse existing customer, dealer, organisation, procedures, and APIs where practical.
- Use SSO and organisation/dealer-level authorisation.

3. Design Principles

- Ultra-simple user experience.
- Dashboard-first home page.
- One consolidated Complaints list instead of separate pages for every status.
- One Complaint Details workspace containing details, activity, communication, and actions.
- Minimum required data entry.
- Avoid unnecessary duplication of customer and vehicle master data.
- Do not replicate exstoAssist complexity unless there is a confirmed business requirement.

4. Scope – MVP

4.1 Core Functionality

- Complaint registration.
- Complaint search and filtering.
- Complaint lifecycle management.
- Complaint assignment to a user.
- Complaint status management.
- Customer identification/search.

- Optional vehicle registration capture.
- Activity/timeline history.
- Email communication.
- Phone interaction outcome recording.
- Complaint resolution and closure.
- Dashboard and basic reporting.
- SSO authentication.
- Role and organisation/dealer-based access control.

4.2 Potentially Out of Scope for MVP

- Public customer login and self-service complaint portal.
- Direct integration with every dealer website.
- WhatsApp integration.
- SMS integration.
- Complex telephony/extension mapping.
- Full customer and vehicle data replication.
- Complaint severity/priority classification.
- Complex workflow engine.
- Large dealer master-data migration.

5. Proposed Navigation

- Home – Dashboard.
- Complaints – Search, filter, and manage all accessible complaints.
- New Complaint – Create a new complaint.
- Reports – Simple charts and exports.
- Settings – Administration for authorised users only.

The application should not have separate navigation items for My Complaints, Assigned, Unassigned, Reopened, Resolved, Closed, Archived, or Trash. These should be filters or views within the consolidated Complaints page.

6. Home Page – Dashboard

The Dashboard is the recommended home page. Its purpose is to answer three questions immediately: How many complaints do we have? What is their current status? What needs attention?

6.1 KPI Cards

- Total Complaints
- New
- In Progress
- Resolved
- Closed

6.2 Dashboard Charts

- Complaint Trend – Line chart showing complaint volume over time, with 7-day, 30-day, 3-month, and custom date ranges.
- Complaints by Category – Bar chart showing complaint volume by category.

- Status Distribution – Optional donut/pie chart showing the proportion of complaints by status.

6.3 Requires Attention

- Unassigned complaints.
- Complaints awaiting customer response.
- Complaints open for an extended period.
- Other actionable complaints based on business rules.

7. Complaints List Screen

The Complaints page should consolidate the ticket views seen in exstoAssist into one simple list.

7.1 Search and Filters

- Search by complaint ID, customer, subject, email, mobile, or vehicle registration.
- Filter by Status.
- Filter by Category.
- Filter by Assigned To.
- Filter by Dealer/Centre.
- Filter by Date range.

7.2 Recommended List Columns

- Complaint ID
- Customer Name
- Subject
- Category
- Dealer/Centre
- Assigned To
- Status
- Created Date
- Last Updated

8. New Complaint Screen

The complaint creation form should be short and divided into three sections.

8.1 Customer

- Search existing customer by name, email, or mobile.
- Customer ID, when available.
- Customer Name.
- Email.
- Mobile Number.
- Option to add a new customer when no existing match is found.

8.2 Complaint

- Subject – Required.
- Category – Required.
- Vehicle Registration – Optional.

- Complaint Description – Required.

8.3 Assignment

- Dealer/Centre – preferably pre-populated from user context.
- Assign To – Optional or defaulted based on workflow.
- Status – Default to New.

Recommended minimum required fields: customer identification/name, subject, category, and complaint description.

9. Complaint Details Screen

The Complaint Details screen is the primary work area. It should combine complaint information, customer information, assignment, status, communication, activity history, and actions.

9.1 Summary Information

- Complaint ID
- Subject
- Category
- Dealer/Centre
- Vehicle Registration, if applicable
- Created Date
- Created By
- Current Status
- Assigned To

9.2 Customer Panel

- Customer Name
- Email
- Mobile
- Customer ID, if available
- View Customer action, where supported

9.3 Actions

- Change Status
- Change Assignment
- Send Email
- Record Call
- Add Internal Note
- Resolve Complaint
- Close Complaint

10. Activity and Communication Timeline

Every important complaint action should appear in a chronological activity timeline.

- Complaint Created.
- Assignment Changed.
- Status Changed.
- Category Changed.

- Email Sent.
- Email Received.
- Phone Call Recorded.
- Internal Note Added.
- Complaint Resolved.
- Complaint Closed.

11. Communication

11.1 Email

- Send email from the complaint details screen.
- Store sent and received email history against the complaint.
- Use a unique complaint reference to associate replies with the correct complaint.
- Reuse existing email infrastructure or Microsoft Graph integration where practical.
- Prefer dealer-group identity or an approved email relay where supported.

11.2 Phone

- Record call date/time automatically.
- Capture call outcome.
- Capture notes.
- Add the interaction to the complaint timeline.

12. Complaint Status Model

Recommended simple lifecycle:

NEW → IN PROGRESS → AWAITING CUSTOMER ↔ IN PROGRESS → RESOLVED → CLOSED

Optional: CLOSED → REOPENED → IN PROGRESS.

Assignment should be treated as a separate property, not as a status. My Complaints should be a filter, not a status.

13. Complaint Categories

Recommended initial categories:

- Service
- Vehicle
- Sales
- Customer Service
- Call Centre
- Dealership Experience
- Other

Categories should preferably be configurable rather than hardcoded.

14. Recommended Data Fields

14.1 System Fields

- Complaint ID
- Organisation ID
- Dealer ID
- Created Date/Time
- Created By
- Updated Date/Time
- Updated By
- Status
- Assigned To

14.2 Customer Fields

- Customer ID, if available
- Customer Name
- Email
- Mobile Number

14.3 Complaint Fields

- Subject
- Description
- Category
- Status
- Assigned To
- Dealer/Centre
- Vehicle Registration (optional)
- Created Date
- Resolution Date
- Closed Date

14.4 Communication Fields

- Communication Type: Email, Phone, Internal Note
- Direction: Incoming or Outgoing
- Date/Time
- User
- Message/Notes
- Email Message ID, where applicable

14.5 Resolution Fields

- Resolution Summary – Required when resolving
- Resolved By
- Resolved Date
- Closed By
- Closed Date

15. Reports

- Complaints by Status
- Complaints by Category
- Complaints by Dealer
- Complaint Volume Trend
- Average Resolution Time

Reports should support simple date filtering and export to CSV/Excel where required.

16. Proposed Architecture

Recommended logical architecture:

React Frontend → REST API Backend (.NET or Node.js, pending confirmation) → Complaint Database + Existing Customer/Dealer APIs and Procedures + Email Service.

The application should use existing master-data APIs and procedures where practical rather than duplicating large customer, vehicle, and dealer datasets.

17. Security and Authentication

- SSO integration.
- Session timeout and logout handling.
- Cache/session management.
- Role-based access.
- Organisation/dealer-level data isolation.
- Backend/API enforcement of authorisation; UI hiding alone is not sufficient.
- Audit trail for important complaint changes.

18. Proposed Database Model

- Organisation
- Dealer
- Complaint
- ComplaintActivity
- ComplaintCommunication
- ComplaintCategory
- ComplaintStatus
- ComplaintAssignment, if assignment history requires a dedicated structure

Customer and vehicle information should preferably be referenced through existing systems/APIs, with only the necessary complaint-related data stored locally.

19. Proposed API Areas

- /api/auth
- /api/dashboard/summary
- /api/dashboard/trend
- /api/dashboard/by-category

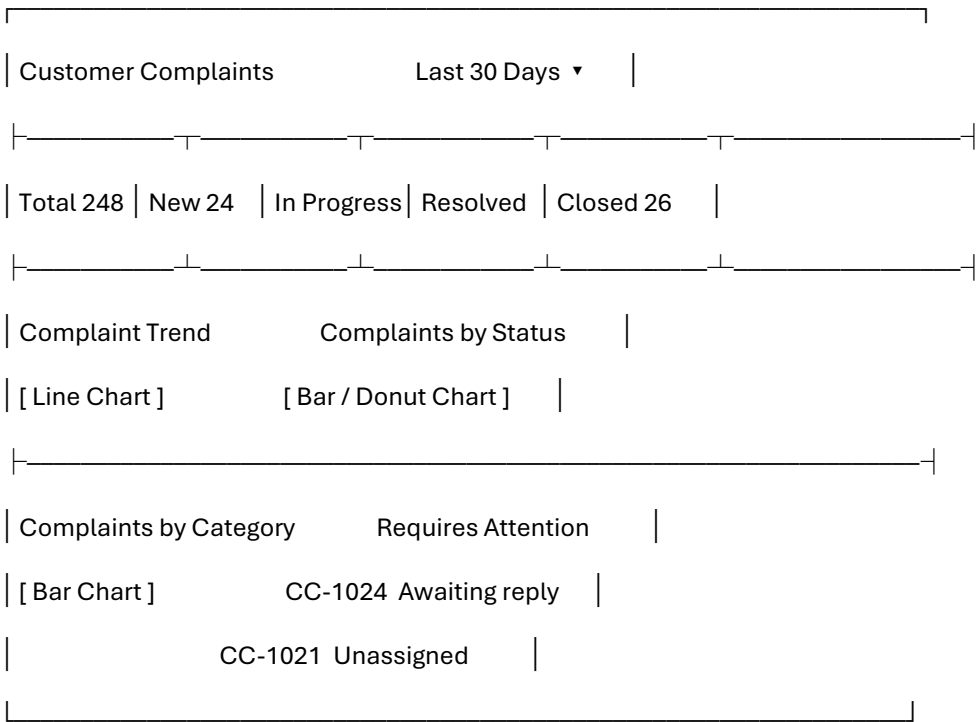
- /api/dashboard/by-status
- /api/complaints
- /api/complaints/{id}
- /api/complaints/{id}/status
- /api/complaints/{id}/assign
- /api/complaints/{id}/activities
- /api/complaints/{id}/communications
- /api/complaints/{id}/email
- /api/complaints/{id}/resolve
- /api/complaints/{id}/close
- /api/customers/search
- /api/dealers/current
- /api/categories
- /api/statuses

20. Proposed Screen Map

- 1. Home / Dashboard
- 2. Complaints List
- 3. New Complaint
- 4. Complaint Details
- 5. Reports
- 6. Settings / Administration

21. Sample Screen Designs – Wireframe Concepts

21.1 Dashboard



21.2 Complaints List

Complaints

+ New Complaint

21.3 New Complaint

Customer: [Search by name, email or mobile]

Name: []

Email: []

Mobile: []

Subject: []

Category: [Service ▾]

Vehicle: [] (Optional)

Description:

[]

[]

Dealer: [Parkway Derby ▾]

Assign To: [Select user ▾]

[Cancel]

[Create Complaint]

21.4 Complaint Details

CC-1024 Vehicle repair delay		● In Progress
Complaint	Customer	
Category: Service	John Smith	
Dealer: Parkway Derby	john@email.com	
Vehicle: AB12 XYZ	07123 456789	
Activity & Communication		
● Email sent to customer		
● Complaint assigned to John		
● Complaint created		
[Add Note] [Record Call] [Send Email] [Resolve] [Close]		

22. Recommended MVP Workflow

User logs in with SSO → Opens Dashboard → Sees KPIs and charts → Clicks a complaint or Complaints list → Searches/filters → Opens Complaint Details → Assigns or updates status → Communicates with customer → Records activities → Resolves → Closes.

23. Key Recommendation

The strongest recommendation is to keep the application intentionally smaller than exstoAssist. The MVP should focus on three core areas: Complaint Handling, Communication, and Reporting. The home page should be a dashboard with quick KPIs and charts. The Complaints page should be a single searchable/filterable list. The Complaint Details page should be the main workspace for all actions. Avoid severity, complex priorities, unnecessary templates, separate folders for every status, and large master-data replication unless a confirmed business requirement requires them.

24. Suggested Figma Make Prototype Order

- Dashboard / Home.
- Complaints List.
- New Complaint.
- Complaint Details with Activity Timeline.
- Email/Communication interaction.
- Reports.
- Settings/Admin.